governor's rule did everything possible to restore peace in the state; that Prime Minister Gandhi and her government sincerely wanted a peaceful solution to the Punjab problem through negotiations with the Akali Dal leadership but it was the unhelpful, adamant and uncooperative attitude of the Akali leaders that caused the talks to fail; and that finally, with no other option left to restore normalcy in Punjab, Indira Gandhi was compelled to approve Operation Blue Star.

The reality, in my perspective, was the opposite. The genesis of the falsehoods can be traced to 1978 , when former chief minister of Punjab Giani Zail Singh advised Indira Gandhi's younger son, Sanjay Gandhi, that the Akali Dal-Janata Party coalition government in Punjab could be destabilized if the moderate policies followed by the senior Akali Dal leadership, comprising Harchand Singh Longowal, Shiromani Gurudwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC) chairman G.S. Tohra and Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal, could come under constant attack by a suitable Sikh sant. [1] If a forceful hard-line Sikh leader emerged as their rival, the moderate Akali leaders would be forced to adopt an uncompromising stance on issues of Sikh interest to retain their following. Any significant shift in the policies of the moderate Akali Dal leaders would naturally not be to the liking of Janata Party leaders, who represented mainly urban Hindu business interests.

With Indira Gandhi's approval sought and Sanjay's ally Kamal Nath on board, [2] Sant Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale of Gurudwara Darshan Prakash at Chowk Mehta was chosen as the sant who would do their bidding in Punjab. Even though the demand for Khalistan was attributed to Bhindranwale to make his anti-moderate Akali leadership campaign more effective, nothing significant was achieved through this part of the operation till January 1980, when Indira Gandhi returned to power as prime minister. The general elections for the eighth Lok Sabha were due before January 1985, and in preparation for them the Congress decided to focus on the Bhindranwale-Khalistan issue. The details of this two-phase special operation are given in this book. For clarity's sake I have named the two phases of this operation as Op-1 and Op-2. I refer to the Punjab-